

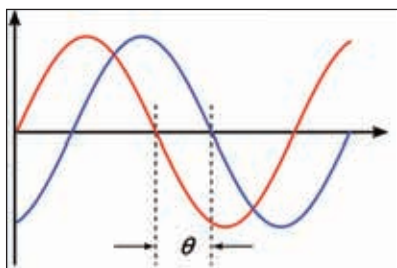
Phase

Phase refers to the relative positioning of a signal with respect to another. Two identical signals, one having 5 V at a given moment while the other has 0 V are said to differ in phase – they are not "in step" one might say.

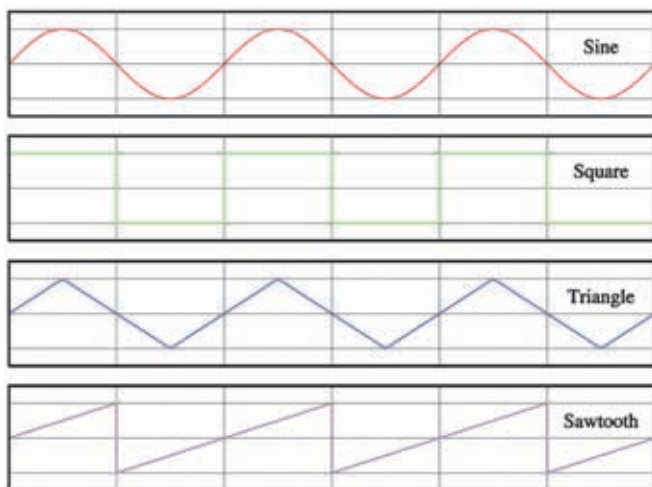
Other properties of a signal include the type, shape, etc.

If the signal varies from one value to another by going through all values possible in between, it is said to be analogue. If it takes certain discrete values and no values in between (sudden changes) it is said to be digital.

How these signals are formed to carry meaningful information forms an important part of communication theory known as modulation.



Two waves differing only in phase.
Sometimes, phase is expressed in terms of angles, with a full time period being 360 degrees.



Various signal waveforms. The picture displays how the parameter varies with time.